

Improving Conditions for Data Enrichment Workers

Resources for AI Practitioners

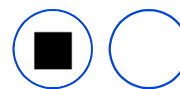
AI is powered by data enrichment workers...

To create today's machine learning (ML) models, AI developers require enriched datasets, vast quantities of information organized by humans so that it can be understood by machines. While these datasets can contain millions of individual entries, the extensive labor that goes into building them is often overlooked, performed by faraway workers under precarious conditions.

...but their contributions are often overlooked

Research shows these workers often face inconsistent and inappropriate compensation for their work, unclear instructions, lack of recognition, and emotional and physical stress related to long, ad-hoc working hours. Under-appreciating the importance of this work doesn't just impact





How can AI companies make data enrichment work better?

AI companies and the people that work for them have the power to improve the lives of data enrichment workers. When designing a project involving enriched data, there are five, worker-centric guidelines that AI practitioners should follow.

Follow these five guidelines:

1. Ensure all data enrichment workers are paid above the local living wage

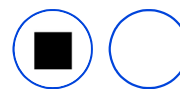


2. Design and run a pilot before launching a data enrichment project



3. Identify appropriate data enrichment workers for the desired task



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5. Establish clear and regular communication mechanisms



These guidelines, based on PAI's responsible sourcing white paper and developed in partnership with DeepMind, have been tested and adopted by DeepMind organization-wide.

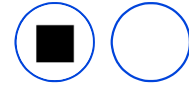
DOWNLOAD THESE GUIDELINES

What resources can help practitioners meet these guidelines?



DATA ENRICHMENT SOURCING GUIDELINES

A shareable PDF listing the five key, worker-centric guidelines that AI practitioners should follow when designing a project involving enriched data

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A PDF listing what should be included in a set of task instructions to make sure they are as clear as possible for data enrichment workers



DATA ENRICHMENT VENDOR COMPARISON TEMPLATE

A Google Sheets template for comparing various vendors of data enrichment services and surfacing relevant worker-centric considerations



LOCAL LIVING WAGES SPREADSHEET TEMPLATE

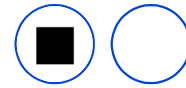
A Google Sheets template to create a centralized resource for looking up wage information about areas where your data enrichment workers live



DEEPMIND CASE STUDY

A case study detailing why DeepMind committed to the Data Enrichment Sourcing Guidelines, how they did it, and the



**PARTNERSHIP ON AI****RESPONSIBLE SOURCING WHITE PAPER**

The original PAI white paper detailing how the choices made by AI practitioners impact data enrichment workers and what they should do about it

When to use these resources:**Before starting a project involving enriched data...**

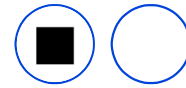
- Read the [Data Enrichment Sourcing Guidelines](#) document, which lists five key, worker-centric guidelines that AI practitioners should follow when designing a project involving enriched data

Before writing task instructions for data enrichment workers...

- Use the [Good Instructions Checklist for Data Enrichment Projects](#), which lists what should be included in a set of task instructions to make sure they are as clear as possible for data enrichment workers

Before setting payments for data enrichment workers...

- Start by referencing Annex 1 of the “[Responsible Sourcing of Data Enrichment Services](#)” white paper to

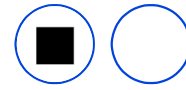
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to fill out the [Local Living Wages Spreadsheet Template](#)

When working with multiple data enrichment platforms or vendors...

- Use the [Data Enrichment Vendor Comparison Template](#) to create a vendor comparison table.
- Work with your team to fill it out, enabling you to quickly identify any vendor-specific data enrichment sourcing guidelines

These resources have been tested by DeepMind

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Watch on

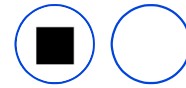
To ensure usability, versions of these resources were tested and implemented in practice by research and development teams at DeepMind. We thank DeepMind for partnering with us to develop, test, and refine these resources. To learn more about how these resources were iteratively developed, read our case study “Implementing Responsible Data Enrichment Practices at an AI Developer: The Example of DeepMind.”

READ THE CASE STUDY

Help us advance this work

To ensure our guidance truly improves conditions for data enrichment workers, we welcome feedback:

- from AI practitioners on usability
- from workers on their resulting experiences

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If you are interested in using our data enrichment and resources or have feedback on how they can be improved, please get in touch.

GIVE YOUR FEEDBACK



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